

FREE BONUS

Canvas & Cord Complete Guide

Everything you need to know about materials

Not all canvas is created equal. This guide breaks down every type of plastic canvas, cord, and thread you'll work with — so you always pick the right material for the right project.

Plastic Canvas Types

Plastic canvas comes in different mesh counts. The count tells you how many holes per inch — lower count = bigger holes = thicker cord.

Mesh Count	Hole Size	Best Cord	Best For
5-count	Large (5mm)	4-5mm rope, thick yarn	Baskets, trivets, structural pieces
7-count (most common)	Medium (3.5mm)	3mm cord, worsted yarn	Placemats, coasters, most projects
10-count	Small (2.5mm)	2mm cord, sport yarn	Detailed patterns, fine work
14-count	Tiny (1.8mm)	1-1.5mm thread	Cross-stitch style, very detailed

Recommendation: Start with 7-count for all the templates in this vault. It's forgiving for beginners, works with the most common cord sizes, and is the easiest to find in stores.

Canvas Shapes Available

- **Standard sheets** — 10.5" × 13.5" (most common size, works for all rectangular projects)
- **Circles** — 3" to 12" diameter (great for coasters and placemats)
- **Ovals** — Various sizes (check template dimensions before buying)
- **Hexagons** — Usually 4-5" across (for hexagonal coasters)
- **Stars** — 4-6" point to point (for decorative coasters)
- **Purse/bag shapes** — Pre-formed 3D shapes

If a shape you need isn't available pre-cut, buy a standard sheet and cut it yourself using the printed template as your guide.

Stiffness Levels

Regular (flexible)

Bends easily. Good for items that need to be rolled or folded (napkin rings, cutlery holders). Most sheets are this type.

Stiff / Ultra-Stiff

Holds its shape firmly. Essential for baskets, trivets, and any piece that needs to stand up or support weight. Usually labeled "ultra-stiff" or "stiffened."

Cord Types Explained

Type	Sizes	Feel	Best For	Price
Cotton macrame cord	2-5mm	Soft, smooth	Placemats, coasters (premium feel)	\$\$
Jute twine	1-4mm	Rough, rustic	Farmhouse style, baskets	\$
Cotton cord (braided)	2-4mm	Firm, round	Structured weaves, table runners	\$\$
Hemp cord	1-3mm	Stiff, textured	Eco/natural projects	\$\$
Acrylic yarn	Worsted weight	Soft, washable	Colorful designs, machine wash items	\$
Metallic cord	1-2mm	Shiny, firm	Holiday pieces, accents	\$\$\$
Jute rope	4-6mm	Very rough, thick	Baskets, trivets, outdoor pieces	\$

Cord Size vs. Canvas Count

This is the most common mistake beginners make — using the wrong cord size for their canvas. Here's the cheat sheet:

Canvas Count	Ideal Cord Size	Too Thin	Too Thick
5-count	4-5mm	Under 3mm (gaps)	Over 6mm (won't fit)
7-count	3mm	Under 2mm (gaps)	Over 4mm (tight)
10-count	2mm	Under 1mm (gaps)	Over 3mm (won't fit)
14-count	1-1.5mm	Under 0.5mm	Over 2mm

Pro tip: When in doubt, buy a small amount of cord and test it on a scrap piece of canvas before committing to a large purchase. The cord should fill the hole snugly without needing to be forced through.

Color Combinations That Sell

Based on bestselling handmade table settings on Etsy and at craft fairs, these are the color combos that customers love:

Natural / Farmhouse

Natural jute + cream cotton + light brown accents. Bestseller for kitchen and dining. Appeals to the widest audience.

Coastal

White cotton + light blue + natural rope. Perfect for summer. Price 10-15% higher than farmhouse — buyers associate it with vacation.

Modern Neutral

Black + cream + grey. Clean, minimal. Attracts younger buyers. Great for coasters and trivets.

Holiday Gold

Metallic gold + deep green or burgundy. Seasonal sellers (Oct-Dec). Price 20-30% higher — holiday buyers are less price-sensitive.

Boho Earth

Mustard + terracotta + cream + sage. Instagram-friendly. Strong demand for table runners and placemats.

How Much Cord Do You Need?

A rough guide for 7-count canvas with 3mm cord:

Project	Cord Needed	Safety Margin
10 cm coaster	~4m	+1m
35 cm round placemat	~20m	+3m
45×30 cm rect placemat	~35m	+5m
120×30 cm table runner	~55m	+8m
Napkin ring	~3m	+0.5m
Bread basket	~25m	+4m

Always buy 15-20% more than the estimate. Running out mid-project with a different dye lot is a common frustration.



Next step: Pick your first template, match it to the right canvas and cord, and start creating.